



THE PREGNANCY PLANNER

A place to plan and prepare, week by week.

START

1ST TRIMESTER

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Getting Started

 About this planner

 How to use it

1st Trimester

 Monthly overview

 Priorities & habits

 Weeks 4 – 12

2nd Trimester

 Monthly overview

 Priorities & habits

 Weeks 13 – 26

3rd Trimester

 Monthly overview

 Priorities & habits

 Weeks 27 – 40

Appointments

 Booking appointment (8 – 12 wks)

 Dating scan (11 – 14 wks)

 Anatomy scan (18 – 21 wks)

 Additional scans (template)

 Midwife appointments

Checklists

 Hospital bag

 Baby essentials

 Admin & work

 Postpartum care

 Signs of labour

Birth Plan

 Vaginal birth plan

 C-section birth plan

Journal

Notes

A note to close

A calm place for everything.

This planner is designed to hold everything pregnancy brings — the appointments, the tasks, the thoughts, and the questions. Not all at once. Just one week at a time.

Each weekly page gives you a gentle structure: a handful of suggested tasks to get you started, space to add your own, a habit tracker for the small daily things, and room to write how you're feeling.

There's no pressure to fill everything in. Use what helps. Leave what doesn't. This is your planner.

HOW TO USE IT

- Weekly pages run from Week 4 to Week 40, each colour-coded by trimester.
- Suggested tasks are pre-printed — tick them off, or ignore them.
- Blank checkboxes at the bottom of each section are yours to fill in.
- Each trimester title page has space to plan the habits you want to establish in that period. Those habits can then be tracked on each weekly page.
- The habit tracker runs Mon–Sun. Write your habit on the line, fill circles as you go.
- Appointments, checklists, your birth plan, and notes pages are at the back.

NAVIGATING YOUR PLANNER

- Tap any tab on the right edge to jump between sections.
- Tap any underlined phrase inside a weekly to-do (e.g. 'dating scan') to jump straight to that page.
- In GoodNotes, links only work when the pen tool is off (Read-Only mode).
- To add more pages, duplicate any page: press and hold the page thumbnail, then select Duplicate.



1ST TRIMESTER

WEEKS 1 – 12

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1st Trimester — Monthly overview

Weeks 1 – 12

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1st Trimester

Weeks 1 – 12

You might not look different yet, but everything is already changing.

This is the quietest trimester from the outside — and often the most overwhelming on the inside. You may feel exhausted in a way that's hard to explain, or nauseous, or both. That's not weakness. That's your body doing something extraordinary.

This trimester is mostly about rest and letting things settle. There isn't much you need to do yet, and that's okay. A few gentle things will come your way — a booking appointment, a first scan — and this planner will walk you through them, one at a time.

For now, be kind to yourself. The planning can wait. You can't do this wrong.

PRIORITIES

- 1 Confirm your pregnancy, start folic acid, and book your first GP / midwife appointment.
- 2 Get your booking appointment and dating scan in the diary — these are the two anchor moments of this trimester. Self-refer to your chosen NHS Trust; check the NHS website for how to find Trusts near you.
- 3 Rest. Be gentle with yourself. Tell only who you want to, when you're ready.

HABITS TO BUILD THIS TRIMESTER

- e.g. Take folic acid daily
- e.g. Rest when you need to

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TO DO

- ☐ Book a GP appointment
- ☐ Start folic acid (400mcg daily)
- ☐ _____

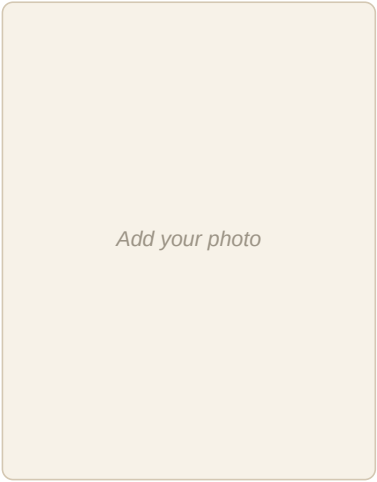
RESEARCH

- Vitamin D in pregnancy
- Listeria and food safety

CONSIDER

- When to tell your employer

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

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TO DO

- ☐ Register with your GP or midwife
- ☐ Note your last menstrual period date
- ☐

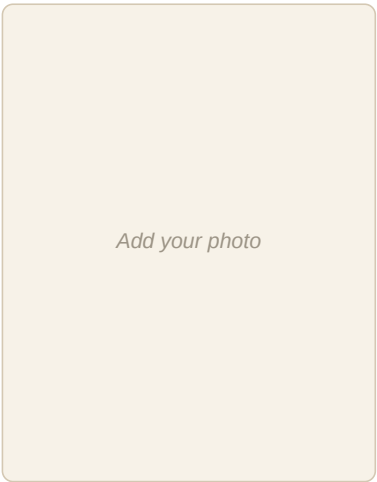
RESEARCH

- How the booking appointment works
- NHS maternity care options

CONSIDER

- Midwife-led or consultant-led care pathway?

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HABITS

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TO DO

- ☐ Book your midwife [booking appointment](#) (ideally by week 8 – 10)
- ☐ Look into pregnancy multivitamins
- ☐

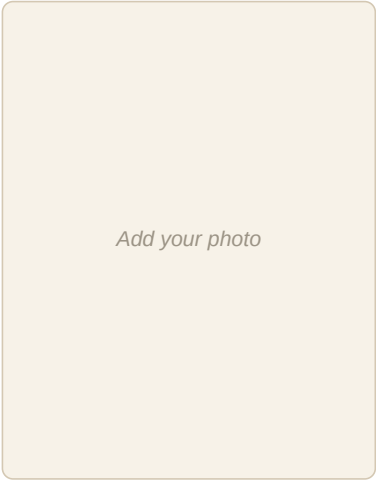
RESEARCH

- What happens at the booking appointment
- Pregnancy vitamins — what's needed

CONSIDER

- NHS midwife, independent midwife, or private care

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TO DO

- ☐ Prepare questions for your [booking appointment](#)
- ☐ Avoid alcohol, raw fish, soft cheeses, and raw meat
- ☐

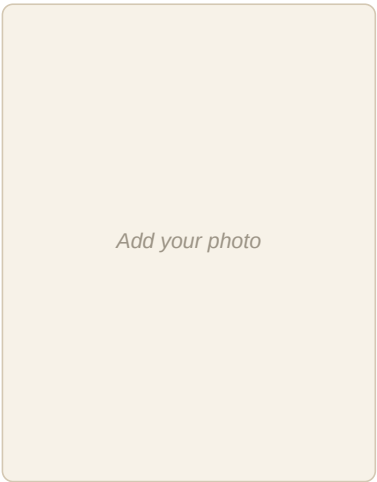
RESEARCH

- Hypnobirthing — what it is, and whether it interests you
- Mental health support in pregnancy

CONSIDER

- Who you want to attend scans and appointments with you

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TO DO

- ☐ Attend booking appointment (if booked)
- ☐ Complete blood tests requested at booking
- ☐ _____

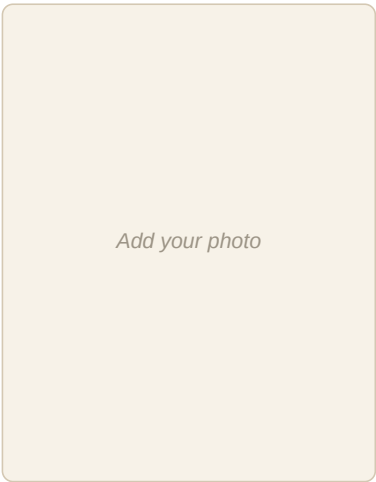
RESEARCH

- Down's, Edwards' and Patau's screening — how it works
- NIPT (non-invasive prenatal testing) options

CONSIDER

- Whether to opt into combined screening at 11 – 13 weeks

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

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TO DO

- ☐ Rest when you need to — fatigue is normal
- ☐ Research maternity pay and leave entitlements
- ☐

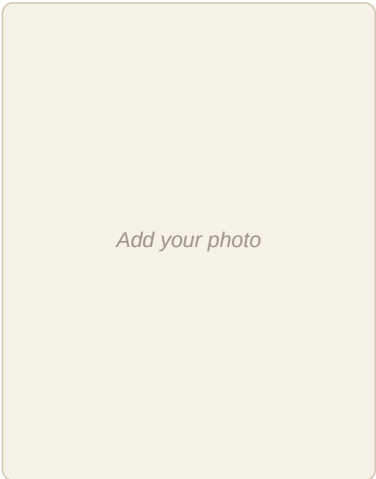
RESEARCH

- Statutory vs occupational maternity pay
- Maternity Allowance if self-employed
- Shared parental leave

CONSIDER

- When to tell your employer (legal deadline is week 25)

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TO DO

- ☐ Book your [12-week dating scan](#) if not yet done
- ☐ Think about who you want at your scan
- ☐ _____

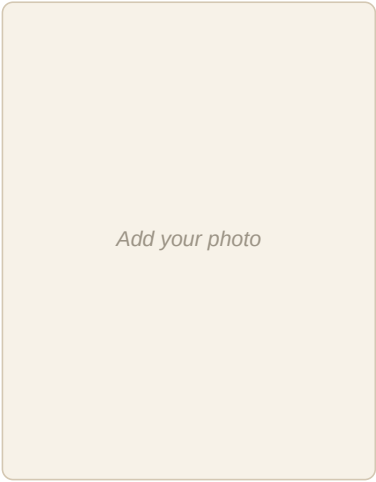
RESEARCH

- What happens at the 12-week scan
- How combined screening results are interpreted

CONSIDER

- Who will be your primary support person?

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TO DO

- ☐ Prepare questions for your sonographer
- ☐ Note any symptoms to mention to your midwife
- ☐

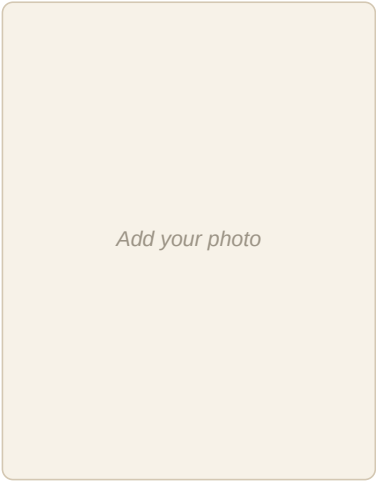
RESEARCH

- Signs of miscarriage and when to seek help
- Ectopic pregnancy symptoms — worth knowing

CONSIDER

- When to share your news more widely

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TO DO

- ☐ Attend your [12-week dating scan](#)
- ☐ Review combined screening results with midwife
- ☐

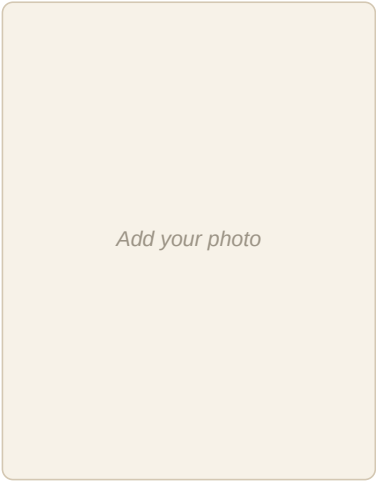
RESEARCH

- What 'low' and 'higher' risk screening results mean
- NIPT if you want further reassurance

CONSIDER

- Telling close family and friends after the scan

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HABITS

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2ND TRIMESTER

WEEKS 13 – 26

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2nd Trimester — Monthly overview

Weeks 13 – 26

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2nd Trimester

Weeks 13 – 26

This is where most women find their breath again.

The fog of the first trimester tends to lift, and with it comes a little more space to think, to plan, and to even enjoy this. Your bump will start to show. At some point, you'll feel movement — and that moment tends to make everything feel more real.

This is a good time to start thinking ahead, gently. Not all at once — just a little each week. Appointments to book, things to look into, lists to begin. Nothing is urgent. Everything has time.

Use this trimester to get curious, not busy. There's a difference.

PRIORITIES

- 1 Attend your anatomy scan and midwife appointments — note results and questions in this planner.
- 2 Begin lists you'll keep coming back to — hospital bag, baby essentials, birth preferences.
- 3 Tell your employer (legal deadline week 25) and start a maternity leave plan.

HABITS TO BUILD THIS TRIMESTER

- e.g. Gentle exercise (walk / swim / yoga)
- e.g. Track baby movements once you feel them

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TO DO

- ☐ Book your [anatomy scan](#)
- ☐ Consider sharing pregnancy news more widely
- ☐

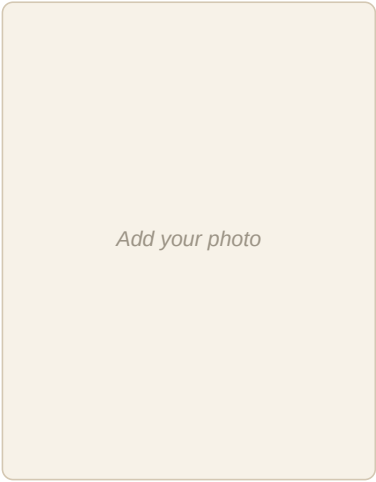
RESEARCH

- Second trimester — what to expect physically
- Free NHS dental treatment in pregnancy

CONSIDER

- When to tell your employer (must be by week 25)

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HABITS

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TO DO

- ☐ Research maternity leave options in detail
- ☐ Speak to HR about your company's maternity policy
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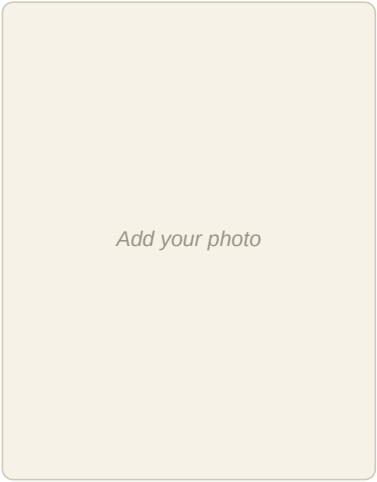
RESEARCH

- Pram types — travel system vs pushchair vs pram
- Car seat safety — infant carrier vs i-Size

CONSIDER

- Start a list of big-ticket baby items to budget for

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

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TO DO

- ☐ Start a baby names list if you'd like
- ☐ Explore antenatal class options — popular ones book up early
- ☐

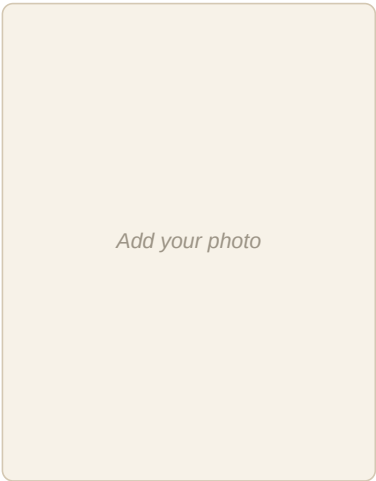
RESEARCH

- NCT classes vs NHS antenatal classes
- Online vs in-person antenatal options

CONSIDER

- Nursery ideas — no pressure, just early inspiration

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HABITS

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TO DO

- ☐ Attend midwife appointment
- ☐ Think about your birth preferences — no rush
- ☐ _____

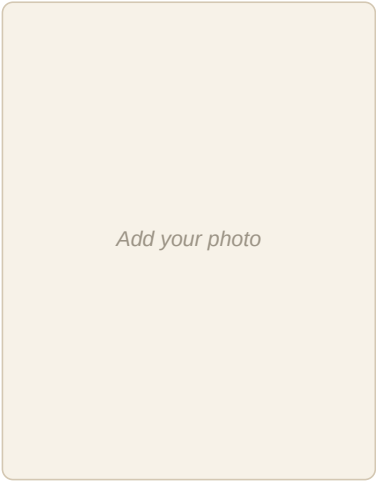
RESEARCH

- What to expect at the 16-week midwife appointment
- Braxton Hicks vs real contractions

CONSIDER

- You may start to feel early movements (quickening)

PROGRESS PHOTO



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TO DO

- ☐ Book antenatal classes if not yet done
- ☐ Research hospitals or birth centres nearby
- ☐

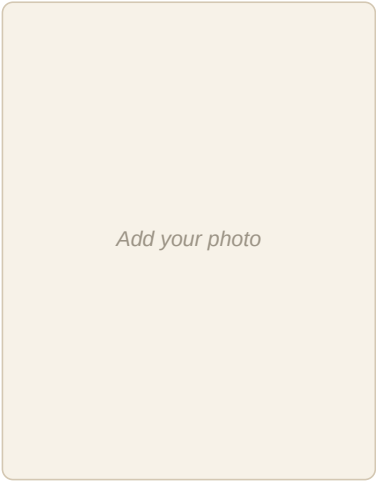
RESEARCH

- Birth centre vs labour ward vs home birth
- Water birth options

CONSIDER

- Who will be your birth partner — have the conversation

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

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TO DO

- ☐ Book your anatomy scan if not yet done
- ☐ Start thinking about birth preferences formally
- ☐ _____

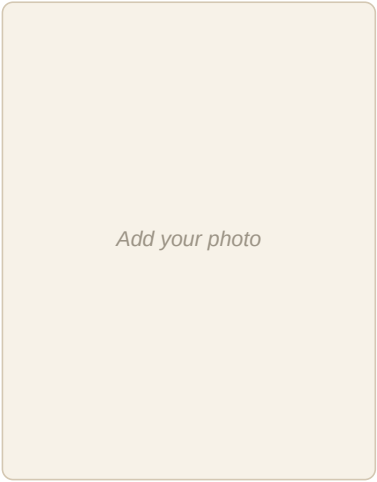
RESEARCH

- Prams and car seats — test in person if possible
- Hypnobirthing courses — book early

CONSIDER

- Start a hospital bag list (early is fine)

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

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TO DO

- ☐ Prepare questions for your anatomy scan
- ☐ Think about hospital bag basics
- ☐ _____

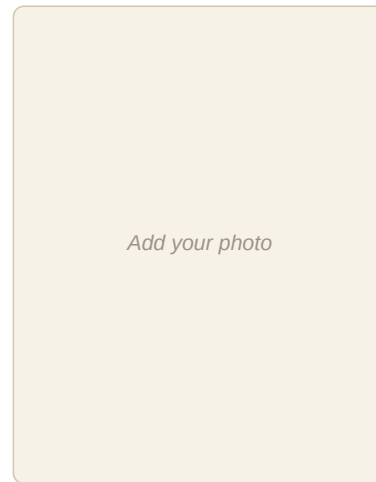
RESEARCH

- What the anatomy scan checks for
- Placenta previa — what it means if detected

CONSIDER

- Rest when you can — your body is growing fast now

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

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TO DO

- ☐ Attend your anatomy scan
- ☐ Note scan results and any follow-up needed
- ☐ _____

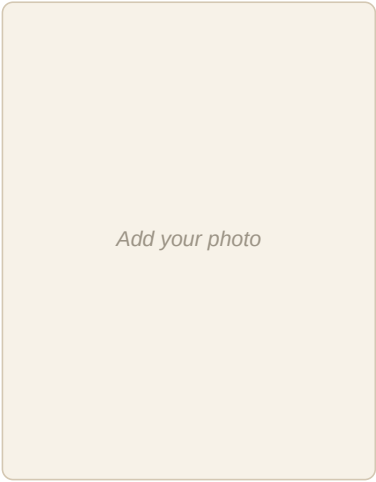
RESEARCH

- Fetal movements — when they become regular
- Iron levels in pregnancy — dietary sources

CONSIDER

- Celebrate — you're halfway there

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

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TO DO

- ☐ Discuss scan results with your midwife
- ☐ Start your hospital bag list formally
- ☐ _____

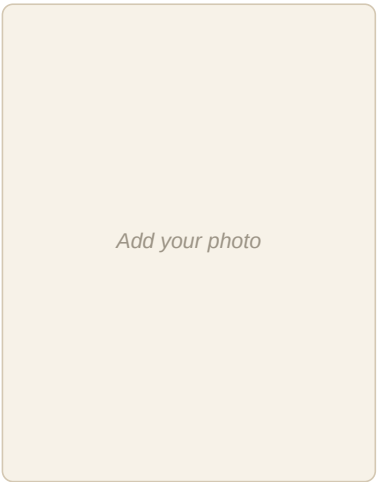
RESEARCH

- Baby monitors — audio vs video, smart options
- Breastfeeding vs formula — explore both, no pressure

CONSIDER

- Childcare — nurseries can have long waiting lists

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

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TO DO

- ☐ Research childcare options and register interest on waiting lists
- ☐ Look into your employer's enhanced maternity policy
- ☐

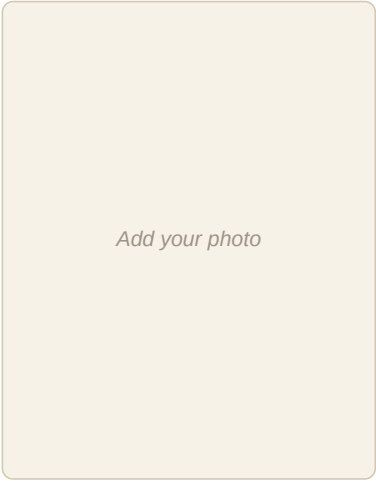
RESEARCH

- Childcare costs and the 15 / 30 free hours scheme
- Nursery, childminder, nanny — differences and costs

CONSIDER

- Research prams — test a few in person if possible

PROGRESS PHOTO



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TO DO

- ☐ Book antenatal classes if not yet started
- ☐ Start a postpartum plan — meals, support, rest
- ☐ _____

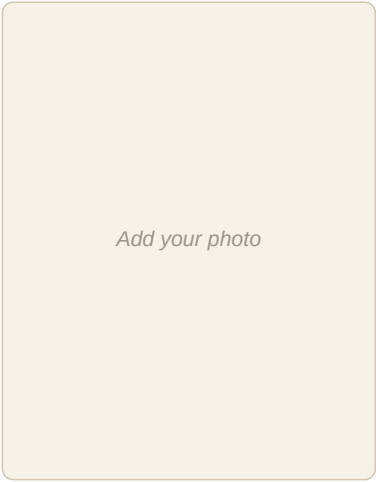
RESEARCH

- The fourth trimester — what recovery looks like
- Postpartum mental health — signs of PND

CONSIDER

- Confirm your birth partner understands the role

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

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_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

NOTES

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Attend midwife appointment
- ☐ Review your baby budget and priorities
- ☐

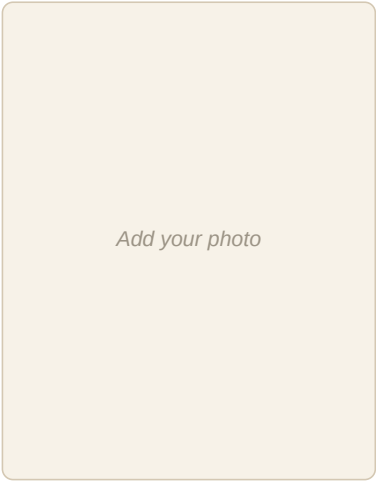
RESEARCH

- Glucose tolerance test — if at risk of GD
- Perineal massage — when and how to start

CONSIDER

- What you truly need for the nursery vs nice-to-have

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
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	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

NOTES

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

APPOINTMENTS

CHECKLISTS

BIRTH PLAN

JOURNAL

NOTES

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Notify employer of pregnancy (legal deadline)
- ☐ Submit MATB1 form once received from midwife
- ☐

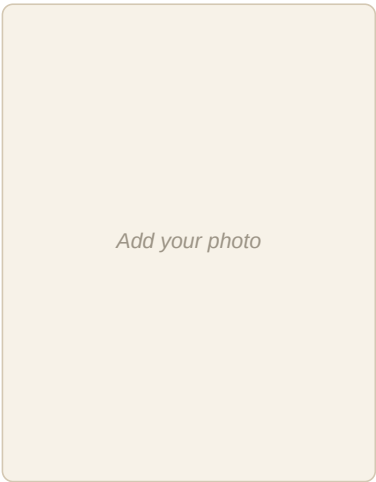
RESEARCH

- The MATB1 form — what it is and when you get it
- SMP eligibility criteria

CONSIDER

- Draft your birth preferences — a first attempt

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
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	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

NOTES

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Submit maternity leave paperwork to HR
- ☐ Confirm your last working day in writing
- ☐

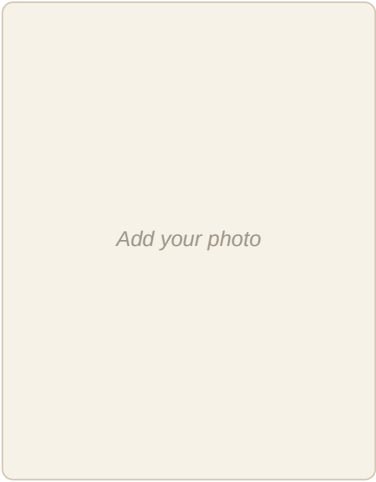
RESEARCH

- Shared parental leave — if relevant
- Keeping-in-touch (KIT) days — what they are

CONSIDER

- Start thinking about a work handover plan

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
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	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

NOTES



3RD TRIMESTER

WEEKS 27 – 40

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

APPOINTMENTS

CHECKLISTS

BIRTH PLAN

JOURNAL

NOTES

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

APPOINTMENTS

CHECKLISTS

BIRTH PLAN

JOURNAL

NOTES

3rd Trimester

Weeks 27 – 40

You're in the home stretch — and you're more ready than you feel.

Things might feel heavier now — physically and emotionally. That's real, and it's okay. Your body is preparing for something remarkable, and it's allowed to take up space doing so.

This trimester is about getting ready, not perfect. A bag packed. A few preferences written down. A little more rest wherever you can find it. The to-do list in this planner will feel manageable because it is — it's been designed so nothing sneaks up on you.

You don't need to have everything figured out. You just need to show up. And you already are.

PRIORITIES

- 1 Finalise your hospital bag, car seat, birth preferences, and postpartum essentials.
- 2 Attend more frequent midwife appointments and know the signs of labour.
- 3 Slow down. Stock the freezer. Set up your support network for after birth.

HABITS TO BUILD THIS TRIMESTER

- e.g. Practise breathing techniques
- e.g. Prepare freezer meals

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
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_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Book a hospital or birth centre tour
- ☐ Start gathering items for your [hospital bag](#)
- ☐

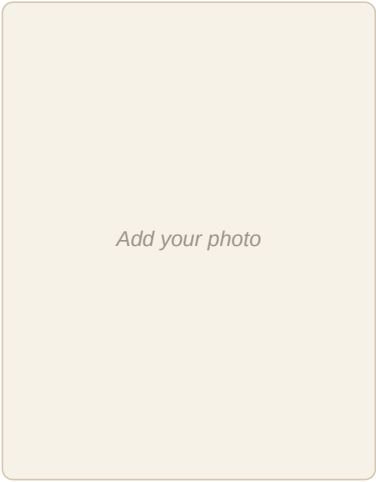
RESEARCH

- Cord blood banking — what it is and costs
- Group B Strep testing — private test from ~35 weeks

CONSIDER

- Who will look after you postpartum — practical support

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
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	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

NOTES

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Attend midwife appointment (blood tests this week)
- ☐ Review your birth preferences document
- ☐ _____

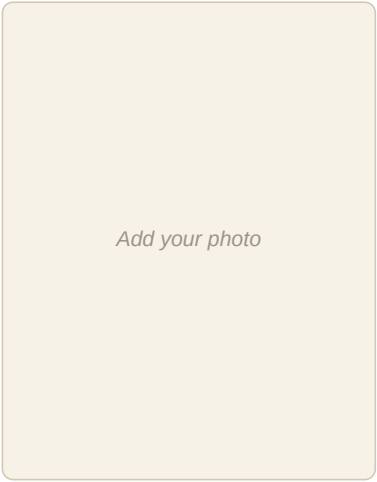
RESEARCH

- Anti-D injection (if Rhesus negative)
- Iron supplements if levels are low

CONSIDER

- Sleep may get harder — start prioritising rest now

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
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_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
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NOTES

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Finalise [nursery essentials](#) purchases
- ☐ Install or plan for [baby's car seat](#)
- ☐ _____

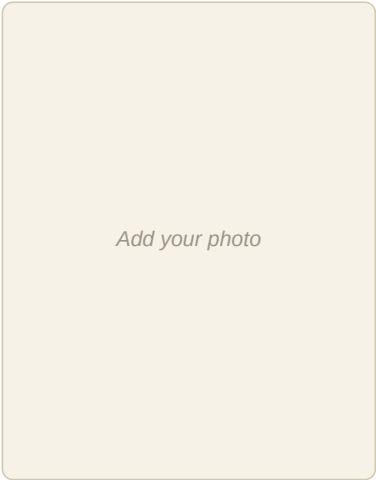
RESEARCH

- Car seat installation — ISOFIX vs belted
- Safe sleep guidelines — The Lullaby Trust

CONSIDER

- Check your hospital bag list — what's still needed?

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

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_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

NOTES

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Start packing your [hospital bag](#)
- ☐ Confirm your birth partner's availability near your due date
- ☐

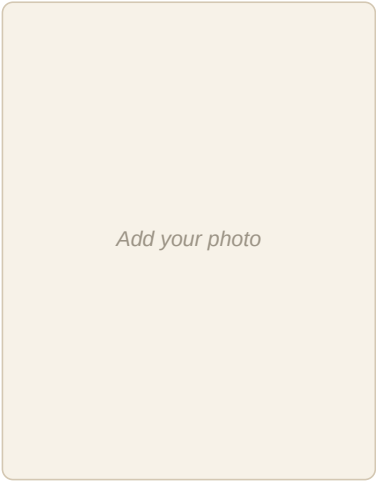
RESEARCH

- Signs of labour — show, waters, contractions
- When to call the hospital

CONSIDER

- Postpartum meals — batch cook or arrange a meal train

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
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	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

NOTES

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Attend antenatal class if still in session
- ☐ Talk through your birth preferences with your midwife
- ☐ _____

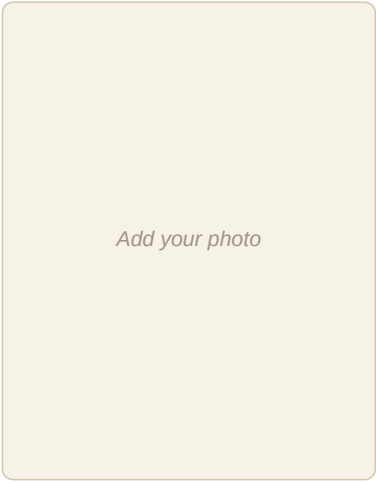
RESEARCH

- Pain relief in labour — gas and air, epidural, TENS
- What a birth plan does and doesn't guarantee

CONSIDER

- It's okay to slow down — physically and at work

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
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_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
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NOTES

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Add key items to [hospital bag](#)
- ☐ Pre-register at your hospital or birth centre
- ☐

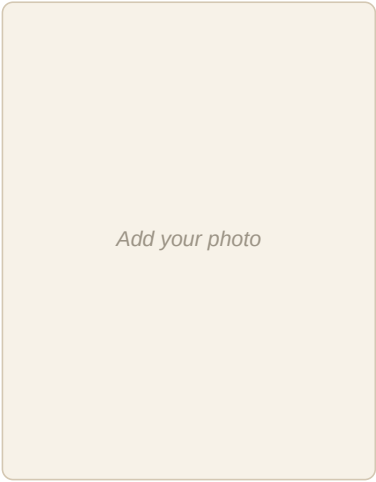
RESEARCH

- Newborn care basics — cord care, bathing, feeding cues
- Colostrum harvesting — what it is, whether to try

CONSIDER

- Discuss any anxieties about birth with your midwife

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

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NOTES

MONDAY

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WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Finalise your [birth preferences](#) document
- ☐ Prepare your home for baby's arrival
- ☐

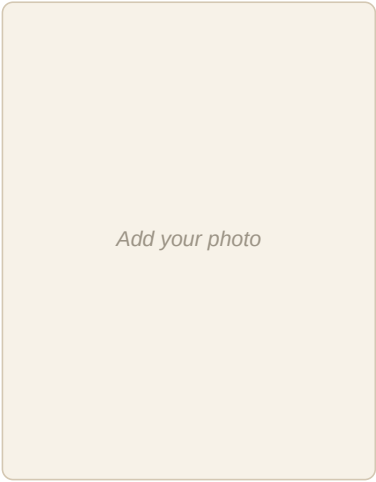
RESEARCH

- Caesarean section — what to expect, planned or emergency
- Perineal massage — continue if started

CONSIDER

- A list of people to notify after birth

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

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MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Attend midwife appointment
- ☐ Prepare list of people to notify after birth
- ☐ _____

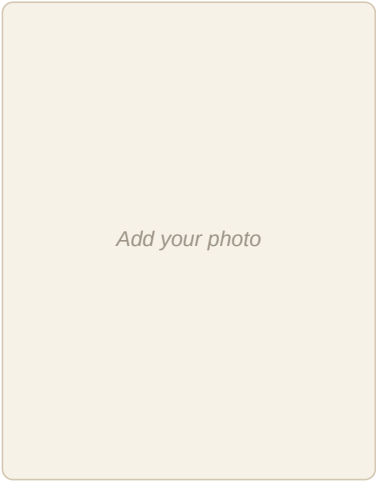
RESEARCH

- Induction of labour — why it happens, what to expect
- Fetal movements — what's normal at this stage

CONSIDER

- Hospital bag should be nearly complete

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

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NOTES

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Check hospital bag is complete
- ☐ Know the signs of labour
- ☐ Consider a private Group B Strep test
- ☐ _____

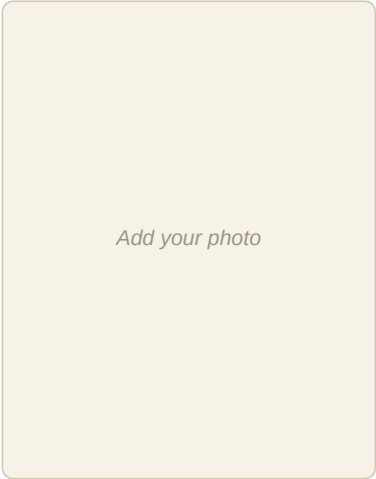
RESEARCH

- Group B Strep — risks and testing
- What to do if your waters break at home

CONSIDER

- Reduce commitments and rest where possible

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
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NOTES

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Weekly midwife appointments begin from now
- ☐ Install car seat and check fitting
- ☐ Stock up on postpartum essentials for yourself
- ☐ _____

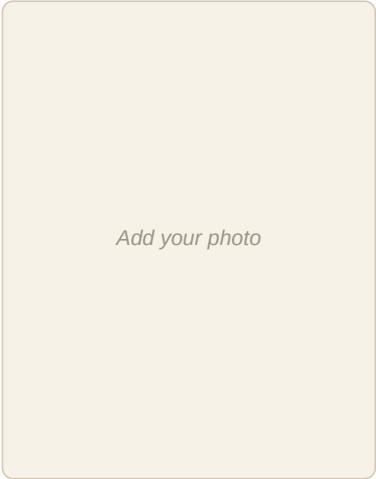
RESEARCH

- Postpartum recovery — what your body will need
- Pelvic floor exercises — continue throughout

CONSIDER

- Prepare a postpartum essentials basket for yourself

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

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_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

NOTES

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Final check on [hospital bag](#)
- ☐ Inform your birth partner to stay on call
- ☐

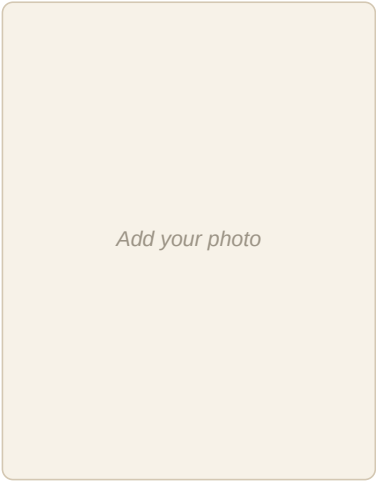
RESEARCH

- Early labour — what to do and when to go in
- The BRAIN acronym for decisions in labour

CONSIDER

- Full term — baby could arrive any time now

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
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NOTES

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Attend weekly midwife appointment
- ☐ Tie up any loose ends at home
- ☐

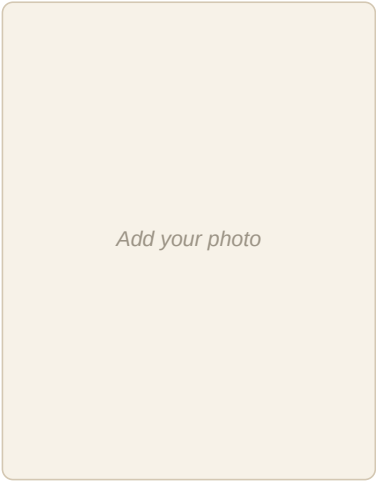
RESEARCH

- Overdue pregnancy — monitoring and options
- Membrane sweep — what it involves

CONSIDER

- Rest as much as possible — a legitimate priority

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
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NOTES

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Stay in contact with your midwife
- ☐ Know when to call your midwife or hospital
- ☐

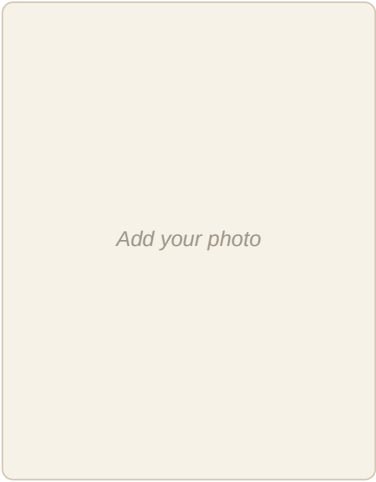
RESEARCH

- Induction — what to expect if offered
- Positions for labour — upright, all fours, etc.

CONSIDER

- Walk gently if it helps you feel settled

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
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NOTES

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

SUNDAY

TO DO

- ☐ Stay in contact with your midwife
- ☐ Rest, breathe, trust yourself
- ☐

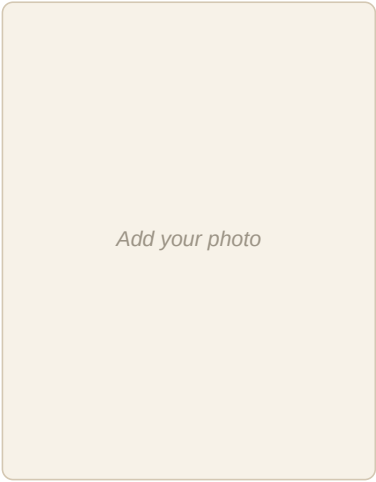
RESEARCH

- Post-dates monitoring — what happens after 40 weeks
- Induction timeline if offered

CONSIDER

- You've done everything you need to do

PROGRESS PHOTO



HABITS

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
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	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
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NOTES



APPOINTMENTS

BOOKING · SCANS · MIDWIFE

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

APPOINTMENTS

CHECKLISTS

BIRTH PLAN

JOURNAL

NOTES

Your first official appointment — usually with your community midwife. Lasts around an hour. You'll talk through your medical history, options for screening, and what NHS care will look like from here.

DATE	TIME
WEEK	PROVIDER
	LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

-
-
-
-
-

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

-
-
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-

Confirms how many weeks pregnant you are and your estimated due date. Usually combined with screening blood tests on the same day.

DATE

TIME

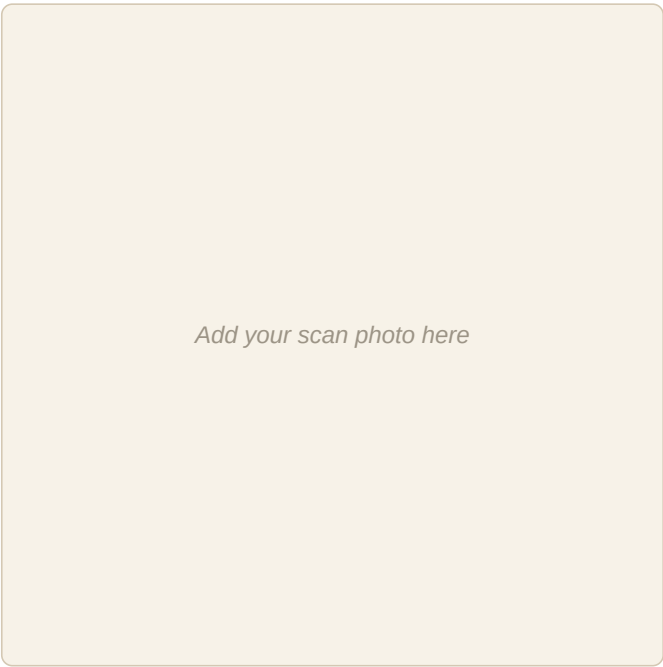
WEEK

SONOGRAPHER

LOCATION

ESTIMATED DUE DATE

SCAN PHOTO



NOTES

NEXT STEPS

- ---
- ---
- ---

A detailed scan checking baby's growth and development — heart, brain, spine, kidneys, limbs, and the position of the placenta. You may also choose to find out the baby's sex.

DATE

TIME

WEEK

SONOGRAPHER

LOCATION

SCAN PHOTO



NOTES

NEXT STEPS

- ---
- ---
- ---

Use this template for any extra scan that doesn't fall within the standard dating or anatomy scan timings — for example, a growth scan, reassurance scan, or follow-up. To add more pages: press and hold the page thumbnail in GoodNotes and select Duplicate.

DATE _____ TIME _____

SCAN TYPE _____

WEEK _____ SONOGRAPHER _____ LOCATION _____

SCAN PHOTO



NOTES

- NEXT STEPS
- _____
 - _____
 - _____

FIRST-TIME MUMS ONLY

This 25-week appointment is only routinely offered to first-time mums in the UK.

DATE

TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

DATE

TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

-
-
-
-

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

-
-
-

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

APPOINTMENTS

CHECKLISTS

BIRTH PLAN

JOURNAL

NOTES

FIRST-TIME MUMS ONLY

This 31-week appointment is only routinely offered to first-time mums in the UK.

DATE

TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

APPOINTMENTS

CHECKLISTS

BIRTH PLAN

JOURNAL

NOTES

DATE

TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

-
-
-
-

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

-
-
-

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

APPOINTMENTS

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JOURNAL

NOTES

DATE

TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

-
-
-
-

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

-
-
-

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

APPOINTMENTS

CHECKLISTS

BIRTH PLAN

JOURNAL

NOTES

DATE

TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

-
-
-
-

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

-
-
-

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

APPOINTMENTS

CHECKLISTS

BIRTH PLAN

JOURNAL

NOTES

FIRST-TIME MUMS ONLY

This 40-week appointment is only routinely offered to first-time mums in the UK.

DATE

TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

DATE

TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

-
-
-
-

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

-
-
-

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

APPOINTMENTS

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BIRTH PLAN

JOURNAL

NOTES

DATE

TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

-
-
-
-

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

-
-
-

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

APPOINTMENTS

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NOTES

Use this template for any midwife appointment that doesn't fall within the standard NHS schedule above. To add more pages: press and hold the page thumbnail in GoodNotes and select Duplicate.

DATE		TIME
WEEK	MIDWIFE	LOCATION
QUESTIONS TO ASK		
NOTES		
NEXT STEPS		



CHECKLISTS

ONE STEP AT A TIME

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

APPOINTMENTS

CHECKLISTS

BIRTH PLAN

JOURNAL

NOTES

FOR YOU — LABOUR

- ☐ Maternity notes
- ☐ Birth plan (printed copy)
- ☐ ID and hospital paperwork
- ☐ Phone and long charger cable
- ☐ Pillow from home
- ☐ Lip balm
- ☐ Hair ties / hairband
- ☐ Snacks (high-energy)
- ☐ Water bottle with straw
- ☐ Flip-flops for the shower
- ☐ TENS machine (if using)
- ☐ Mints / lozenges

FOR YOU — AFTER BIRTH

- ☐ Nightgown / front-opening pyjamas
- ☐ Dressing gown
- ☐ Slippers
- ☐ Comfortable underwear (x5+)
- ☐ Nursing bras (x2)
- ☐ Maternity pads (2 packs)
- ☐ Breast pads
- ☐ Toiletries: toothbrush, dry shampoo, face wipes
- ☐ Going-home outfit (loose)

FOR BABY

- ☐ Sleepsuits / babygros (x3)
- ☐ Vests (x3)
- ☐ Hat (x2)
- ☐ Scratch mitts
- ☐ Socks
- ☐ Cardigan
- ☐ Going-home outfit
- ☐ Nappies (newborn pack)
- ☐ Cotton wool / wipes
- ☐ Muslin cloths (x4)
- ☐ Car seat (fitted in car)
- ☐ Blanket
- ☐ Snowsuit / weather layer (if winter)

FOR YOUR PARTNER

- ☐ Change of clothes
- ☐ Toiletries
- ☐ Snacks and drinks
- ☐ Phone and charger
- ☐ Camera
- ☐ Pillow
- ☐ Cash / card for parking

SLEEPING

- ☐ Cot or Moses basket
- ☐ Mattress (firm, flat, new if possible)
- ☐ Fitted sheets (x3)
- ☐ Sleeping bags (x2, age-appropriate tog)
- ☐ Cellular blankets
- ☐ Baby monitor
- ☐ Blackout blind or cover

FEEDING

- ☐ Nursing pillow
- ☐ Bottles and steriliser (if using formula or pumping)
- ☐ Breast pump (if planning to express)
- ☐ Bibs (x6)
- ☐ Muslin cloths (x10)
- ☐ Bottle brush

CLOTHING (NEWBORN)

- ☐ Sleepsuits / babygros (x7)
- ☐ Vests (x7)
- ☐ Cardigan (x2)
- ☐ Hats (x2)
- ☐ Socks (x3 pairs)
- ☐ Scratch mitts

BATHING

- ☐ Baby bath or bath support
- ☐ Hooded towels (x2)
- ☐ Gentle baby wash
- ☐ Cotton wool

CHANGING

- ☐ Changing mat
- ☐ Changing bag
- ☐ Nappies (newborn pack)
- ☐ Nappy cream
- ☐ Wipes (sensitive)
- ☐ Nappy disposal bin or sacks

OUT AND ABOUT

- ☐ Pram / pushchair
- ☐ Car seat (essential)
- ☐ Sling or carrier (optional)
- ☐ Pram blanket / footmuff
- ☐ Rain cover

DURING PREGNANCY — WORK & HR

- ☐ Notify employer of pregnancy in writing (by week 25)
- ☐ Request a workplace risk assessment
- ☐ Submit MATB1 form once received from midwife
- ☐ Confirm maternity leave start date with HR
- ☐ Discuss enhanced maternity pay (if applicable)
- ☐ Plan a handover for your role

DURING PREGNANCY — FINANCES & ADMIN

- ☐ Check NHS entitlements — free prescriptions and dental
- ☐ Apply for Maternity Allowance (if self-employed)
- ☐ Research Child Benefit (apply after birth)
- ☐ Update wills, insurance, or pension if needed
- ☐ Open a savings account for baby (optional)

AFTER BIRTH

- ☐ Register the birth (within 42 days in England & Wales)
- ☐ Apply for Child Benefit
- ☐ Notify HMRC of new child
- ☐ Add baby to your health insurance
- ☐ Register baby with a GP
- ☐ Apply for childcare hours (15 / 30 free hours)
- ☐ Inform employer of return-to-work date

The fourth trimester is yours too. Stock up on these before baby arrives so you can rest and recover at home without worrying about errands.

BLEEDING & RECOVERY

- ☐ Maternity pads (3+ packs — heavy flow)
- ☐ Disposable underwear or old pants
- ☐ Peri bottle (for rinsing perineum)
- ☐ Witch hazel pads / sitz spray
- ☐ Cooling pads / ice packs
- ☐ Donut cushion (if perineum sore)

BREASTFEEDING

- ☐ Nipple cream (lanolin or coconut)
- ☐ Breast pads (disposable or washable)
- ☐ Nursing bras (x3, soft cotton)
- ☐ Nursing tops or button-front pyjamas
- ☐ Haakaa or silicone pump
- ☐ Heat / cold packs for breasts

REST & COMFORT

- ☐ Loose, comfortable clothing
- ☐ Robe with pockets
- ☐ Slippers
- ☐ Phone charger by the bed
- ☐ Easy-access snacks and water
- ☐ Pillow for nursing position

RECOVERY FROM C-SECTION

- ☐ High-waisted underwear (above the scar)
- ☐ Loose drawstring trousers
- ☐ Scar care: silicone strips or gel
- ☐ Stool softener (ask GP/midwife)
- ☐ Help with stairs and lifting

EMOTIONAL & PRACTICAL

- ☐ List of who to call if you feel low
- ☐ Meal train or batch-cooked freezer meals
- ☐ Pre-arranged help with older children / pets
- ☐ Plan for visitors: how, when, who

Knowing what to look out for — and what's reassuring — helps you feel calmer in the days and weeks before birth. Always trust your instincts and call your midwife or hospital if anything worries you.

EARLY SIGNS

- A 'show' — pink or blood-tinged mucus plug
- Mild cramping or backache that comes and goes
- Nesting urge — sudden energy and tidying
- Loose stools or upset stomach
- Baby moving lower into the pelvis ('lightening')
- Braxton Hicks contractions becoming more frequent

ACTIVE LABOUR

- Regular contractions getting longer, stronger, closer together
- Contractions you can't talk through
- Waters breaking — clear / pale fluid (note time and colour)
- Strong urge to bear down (in established labour)

CALL YOUR MIDWIFE / HOSPITAL IF...

- Contractions are 5 minutes apart, lasting 60 seconds, for 1 hour (5-1-1)
- Your waters break — even if not in labour yet
- Waters are green, brown, or blood-stained
- You notice reduced or changed baby movements
- You have bright red bleeding (more than a smear)
- Severe or persistent headache, visual changes, or swelling
- You feel something isn't right — trust that feeling



BIRTH PLAN

VAGINAL OR C-SECTION

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

APPOINTMENTS

CHECKLISTS

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OVERVIEW

DUE DATE	BIRTH PARTNER — NAME
PREFERRED LOCATION	BIRTH PARTNER — CONTACT
DIETARY REQUIREMENTS / ALLERGIES	

DURING LABOUR — SET UP

WHO I WANT IN THE ROOM	ENVIRONMENT e.g. soft lighting, music etc.
☐ Birth partner only	
☐ No trainees / observers, please	
☐ Limited interruptions where possible	
☐ Same midwife where possible	

HYDRATION

☐ Drinking water / oral fluids as I want
☐ IV fluids only if medically necessary

BIRTHING POSITIONS — WHAT I'D LIKE TO TRY

☐ Upright / standing
☐ On all fours
☐ Side-lying
☐ Water birth (if available)
☐ Birthing ball
☐ Squatting
☐ Whatever feels right in the moment

PAIN RELIEF — IN ORDER OF PREFERENCE

- ☐ No pain relief unless I ask
- ☐ Hypnobirthing techniques / breathing
- ☐ TENS machine
- ☐ Water (bath / pool)
- ☐ Gas and air (Entonox)
- ☐ Pethidine / Diamorphine
- ☐ Epidural
- ☐ Whatever I decide on the day

BABY MONITORING & INTERVENTIONS

- ☐ Intermittent monitoring (preferred)
- ☐ Continuous monitoring only if medically needed
- ☐ Avoid routine vaginal examinations where possible
- ☐ Discuss any intervention with me before it happens

IF ASSISTED DELIVERY BECOMES NEEDED

- ☐ Forceps — discuss with me first
- ☐ Ventouse (vacuum) — discuss with me first
- ☐ Episiotomy — only if necessary, please discuss
- ☐ Unplanned C-section — see my C-section plan

SECOND STAGE — PUSHING

- ☐ Spontaneous pushing — follow my body
- ☐ Coached pushing only if needed
- ☐ Mirror to see baby being born
- ☐ Partner to help guide baby out (if possible)

ANYTHING ELSE

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

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DELAYED CORD CLAMPING

- ☐ Yes — please wait at least 1–3 minutes
- ☐ Yes — until the cord stops pulsating
- ☐ Cord blood banking arranged (private)
- ☐ Partner to cut the cord (if possible)

IMMEDIATE SKIN-TO-SKIN

- ☐ Yes — on my chest immediately if safe
- ☐ Partner to do skin-to-skin if I can't
- ☐ Delay weighing / measuring until after first feed

PLACENTA

- ☐ Active management — injection to deliver placenta
- ☐ Physiological — wait and deliver naturally
- ☐ I'd like to see the placenta
- ☐ We'd like to take the placenta home

FEEDING

- ☐ Breastfeeding — please support first latch
- ☐ Formula feeding from the start
- ☐ Combination feeding
- ☐ Undecided — please support whichever I choose

BABY'S FIRST CHECKS

- ☐ Vitamin K — injection (preferred)
- ☐ Vitamin K — oral doses
- ☐ Decline vitamin K
- ☐ Newborn checks done with me / partner present

IF NICU OR SCBU IS NEEDED

- ☐ Partner to stay with baby at all times
- ☐ Skin-to-skin as soon as it's possible
- ☐ Pump milk for baby as soon as I can
- ☐ Updates every step of the way, please

MY POSTPARTUM CHECKS

- ☐ Privacy for any examinations
- ☐ Same midwife where possible
- ☐ Pain relief offered if needed

Whether planned or unplanned, a C-section is still your birth. These preferences help keep the experience close to what you want, where it's safely possible.

OVERVIEW

DUE DATE / PLANNED DATE

BIRTH PARTNER — NAME

HOSPITAL

DIETARY REQUIREMENTS / ALLERGIES

IN THEATRE

- ☐ Birth partner present throughout
- ☐ Music from my playlist played
- ☐ Drape lowered at the moment of birth (if safe)
- ☐ Quiet talking / commentary as baby is born
- ☐ Explanations from the team as it happens

AS BABY IS BORN

- ☐ Delayed cord clamping where possible
- ☐ Immediate skin-to-skin with me (if safe)
- ☐ Skin-to-skin with partner if I can't
- ☐ Cord blood banking arranged (private)
- ☐ Photos / video allowed

FEEDING & FIRST CHECKS

- ☐ Support for first breastfeed in recovery
- ☐ Formula feeding from the start
- ☐ Vitamin K — injection
- ☐ Vitamin K — oral
- ☐ Baby's newborn checks done with me present

MY RECOVERY

- ☐ Help with first feed when I'm ready
- ☐ Pain relief explained and offered
- ☐ Help mobilising slowly when safe
- ☐ Privacy for examinations

ANYTHING ELSE



JOURNAL

Words for the days you want to remember

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

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AND HERE YOU ARE

However you arrived here — through long nights of nausea, the weight of a third trimester body, the rush of a quick labour or the slow patience of a long one — you have done something extraordinary.

Your body has grown, stretched, ached, and remade itself. Your mind has held excitement, fear, joy, and the quiet kind of love that only this moment makes.

There will be more days ahead with their own kind of hard. There will be more days ahead with their own kind of joy. Both are yours, and you are ready for both.

Wishing you slow mornings, soft landings, and a deep, settled love with your new baby.

Welcome to the rest of it.